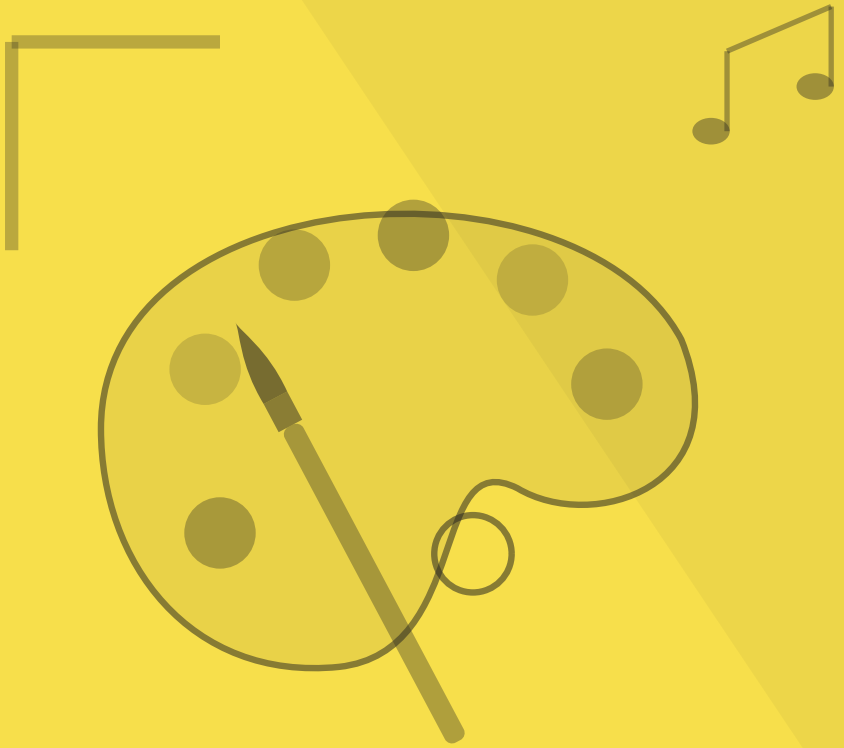
VENVLEARNING

STUDENT TEXTBOOK



Art

GRADE 4

Lessons, examples, and practice for the whole year

2 units

VENVLEARNING

Grade 4
Art

STUDENT TEXTBOOK

Unit 1 The Elements of Art
Unit 2 Art Around the World

A VenvLearning family homeschool curriculum

How to use this book

Every lesson starts on a new page with the same parts, so you always know where to look. Read about the idea, study the Step by Step demonstrations, then make art in the Create studio activity. Your practice pages are in your Student Workbook, labeled with the same lesson number.

- Today's Goal (the box with the target) says what you will be able to do by the end of the lesson.
- Today's Assignment is your checklist for the day. Tick each box as you finish it.
- Each lesson page has three panels. The wide center panel is the lesson, in numbered steps: 1 Get Ready, 2 Learn, and 3 Check Your Understanding.
- The left panel holds things to remember: Key Ideas (the most important rule or fact; learn these), Watch Out warnings about common mistakes, tips, and a Remember note that sums up the lesson. Each one sits beside the part of the lesson it goes with.
- The right panel holds Words to Know (definitions), what to read in your Reader, and other extras.
- Pages that look like a page from a book, on cream paper with a brown READING tab, are things to read: stories, excerpts, and articles.
- Create boxes are studio activities. Keep everything you make in your portfolio folder.
- At the end of each week of lessons there is a short Sketchbook Check in your workbook. Each unit ends with the Portfolio Review.

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UNIT 1

The Elements of Art

Looking like an artist, line, shape and form, proportion, color, value and contrast, composition, and revision.

Every artwork, from a cave painting to a cartoon, is built from the same ingredients: line, shape, form, color, value, texture, and space. In this unit you'll learn to look like an artist, then practice each element in your own work, plan a composition, and use feedback to make a finished piece for your portfolio.

In this unit you will…

- Observe and describe art using the elements of art.
- Use line, shape, form, and proportion in drawings.
- Mix colors, make value scales, and use contrast.
- Plan compositions and revise with feedback.

ART IN YOUR WORLD

Designers, illustrators, architects, and photographers use the elements of art every day, and so does anyone who arranges a poster, a room, or a plate of food.

UNIT VOCABULARY

elements of art	Line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space.
proportion	Size relationships.
primary colors	Red, yellow, blue.
contrast	A big difference that stands out.
composition	How parts are arranged.
revise	Change and improve.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
1.1	Looking Like an Artist
1.2	Line
1.3	Shape and Form
1.4	Proportion
1.5	Color
1.6	Value and Contrast
1.7	Composition
1.8	Revision and Kind, Specific Feedback

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.1
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.1: Looking Like an Artist

TODAY'S GOAL

I can look closely at artwork and describe what I see using the elements of art.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Re8

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Nature Observation Sketch.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.1 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Look at any picture on your wall for one whole minute without talking. What did you notice in the last 30 seconds that you missed at first?

2 Learn

Artists are expert lookers. Before they make art, they spend a lot of time observing: noticing shapes, colors, and tiny details most people walk past. When we talk about art, we use the elements of art, the building blocks every artist uses.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

elements of art
The building blocks artists use: line, shape, form, color, value, texture, and space.

observe
To look closely and carefully.

artwork
Something an artist makes, such as a painting, sculpture, or print.

REMEMBER

Element	What it is
line	a mark that moves from one point to another
shape	a flat area with edges (2-D)
form	a shape with depth, like a ball or box (3-D)
color	what we see when light reflects off something: red, blue, yellow, and more
value	how light or dark something is
texture	how something feels, or looks like it would feel
space	the area around, between, and inside things

Walter Anderson (1903–1965) was an artist from Ocean Springs, Mississippi. He rowed a small boat out to Horn Island in the Gulf of Mexico and spent days drawing and painting the birds, crabs, plants, and waves he found there. He looked so closely that his watercolors seem to move. He's a great example of an artist who learned by observing.

STEP BY STEP · SEE, THINK, WONDER

Use these three steps to look at any artwork.

1 See: What do you see? Name only what is really there (colors, lines, objects).

2 Think: What do you think is going on? Why?

3 Wonder: What questions do you have?

Look for: Slow, careful looking first; ideas and questions second.

CREATE · NATURE OBSERVATION SKETCH

How much can you notice in 10 minutes?

You need: pencil; drawing paper; a leaf, flower, shell, or pinecone.

1 Set your object in front of you.

2 Look for one full minute before you draw.

3 Draw it slowly, looking at the object more than at your paper.

4 Add three labels for details you noticed (veins, spots, edges).

Record: your sketch with three labeled details.

KEY IDEA

Artists look closely first. The elements of art (line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space) give us words for what we see.

✓ REMEMBER

Look closely; use the elements of art to describe what you see.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.1, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name three elements of art.
2. Where did Walter Anderson go to draw nature?
3. What are the three steps of See, Think, Wonder?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.2
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.2: Line

TODAY'S GOAL

I can create different kinds of lines and use them to show movement and feeling.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Line Sampler and Line Feelings.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.2 (Parts B–D).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Draw a line that looks calm. Now draw a line that looks excited. What's different?

2 Learn

Line is the first element most artists use. Lines can be straight, curved, zigzag, wavy, spiral, dotted, thick, or thin. Lines also carry feelings: flat horizontal lines feel calm and restful, tall vertical lines feel strong, and slanted diagonal lines feel full of movement.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

line
A mark that moves from one point to another.

contour line
A line that shows the outside edge of a shape.

implied line
A line we imagine, like the path your eye follows.

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE



In The Starry Night (1889), Vincent van Gogh used thick, swirling, curving lines to make the night sky look like it is moving. Find a picture of it online or in a library book and trace the swirls with your finger.

KEY IDEA

Lines can be many kinds, and their direction and shape carry feeling: horizontal = calm, vertical = strong, diagonal = movement.

CREATE · LINE SAMPLER AND LINE FEELINGS

How can lines show feelings?

You need: pencil; black marker; paper.

1. Fold a paper into eight boxes.
2. Fill each box with a different kind of line (straight, curved, zigzag, wavy, spiral, dotted, thick, thin).
3. On a new paper, draw a simple landscape using only lines that feel calm.
4. Draw the same landscape again using only lines that feel stormy.

Record: both landscapes and a sentence about which lines you chose.

✓ REMEMBER

Lines vary in type and direction, and they carry feeling.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.2, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What feeling do horizontal lines often show?
2. What kind of line shows the outside edge of a shape?
3. What kind of lines did van Gogh use in the sky?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.3
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.3: Shape and Form

TODAY'S GOAL

I can tell shapes from forms, sort shapes as geometric or organic, and use shading to make a shape look 3-D.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: From Shape to Form.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.3 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Is a circle the same as a ball? How could you draw a circle so it looks like a ball?

2 Learn

Shapes are flat (two-dimensional). Geometric shapes have exact edges; organic shapes are free and irregular, like things in nature. Forms are three-dimensional: a circle becomes a sphere, a square becomes a cube, a triangle becomes a cone or pyramid.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

geometric shape
A shape with exact, regular edges, like a circle, square, or triangle.

organic shape
A free-flowing shape like those found in nature, such as a leaf or a puddle.

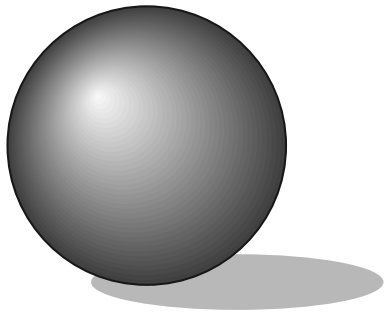
form
An object with three dimensions: height, width, and depth.

shading
Adding darker values to show where light doesn't reach.

REMEMBER

Shape (2-D)	Form (3-D)
circle	sphere (ball)
square	cube (box)
rectangle	cylinder or rectangular prism
triangle	cone or pyramid

In his last years, Henri Matisse “drew with scissors,” cutting bold organic shapes from painted paper, as in The Snail (1953). Artists can also turn a flat shape into a form by shading: darker values on the side away from the light.



Shading turns a flat circle into a round form.

KEY IDEA

Shapes are flat; forms have depth. Shading on the side away from the light turns a shape into a form.

CREATE · FROM SHAPE TO FORM

How can shading make a shape look three-dimensional?

You need: pencil; paper; a ball or orange and a lamp or window light.

1. Draw a circle. Decide where the light is coming from.
2. Shade the side away from the light darker, blending smoothly.
3. Leave a small bright spot (highlight) near the light side.
4. Add a shadow on the ground under the ball.

Record: your shaded sphere and a flat circle side by side.

✓ REMEMBER

Shapes are flat; shading makes forms look 3-D.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Write geometric or organic, or answer the question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.3, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Geometric or organic: a leaf
2. What form does a circle become?
3. Where does shading go?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.4
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.4: Proportion

TODAY'S GOAL

I can use proportion to draw a face with parts in the right size and place.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Cr3

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Proportional Self-Portrait.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.4 (Parts B–D).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Where are your eyes on your head: near the top, or halfway down? Make a guess, then check in a mirror with a ruler.

2 Learn

Proportion means the size relationships between parts. Most people draw eyes too high! On most faces, the eyes are about halfway between the top of the head and the chin. Artists use guidelines to place features.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

proportion
How the sizes of parts compare with each other and with the whole.

scale
The size of something compared with something else.

portrait
A picture of a person, often the face.

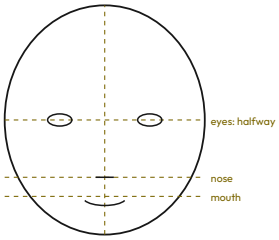
REMEMBER

Face guide: draw an oval. A line halfway down shows where the eyes go.

The bottom of the nose is about halfway between the eyes and the chin.

The mouth is about one-third of the way from the nose to the chin.

Eyes are about one eye-width apart.



WORDS & MORE

Artists sometimes break proportion on purpose. Cartoonists draw big heads and huge eyes to look cute or funny. That's called exaggeration.

KEY IDEA

Proportion is size relationships. Eyes sit about halfway down the head.

CREATE · PROPORTIONAL SELF-PORTRAIT

Can guidelines help you draw a face that looks right?

You need: pencil; eraser; mirror; paper.

1. Draw a large oval. Lightly draw the halfway line and a center line.
2. Place the eyes on the halfway line, one eye-width apart.
3. Add the nose and mouth using the guide.
4. Look in the mirror to add hair, ears (between the eye line and nose line), and details.
5. Erase the guidelines.

Record: your self-portrait.

✓ REMEMBER

Use guidelines: eyes halfway, nose and mouth below.

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.4, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where are the eyes on most faces?
2. Where do the ears usually line up?
3. What is exaggeration?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.5
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.5: Color

TODAY'S GOAL

I can name primary, secondary, and tertiary colors and mix secondary colors.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Paint a Color Wheel.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.5 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

If you only had red, yellow, and blue paint, how many colors could you make?

2 Learn

The painter's color wheel starts with three primary colors: red, yellow, and blue. Mix two primaries to get a secondary color: red + yellow = orange, yellow + blue = green, blue + red = violet. Mix a primary with a neighboring secondary to get a tertiary color, such as yellow-green or red-violet.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

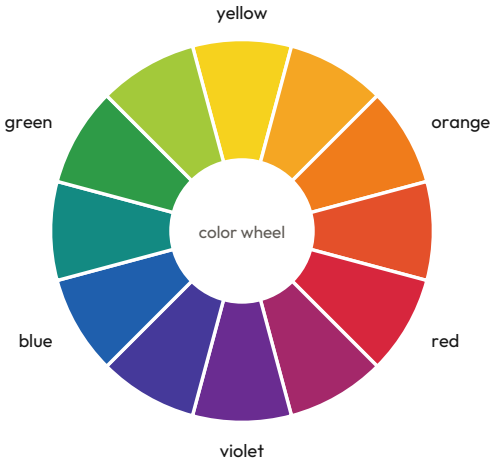
primary colors
Red, yellow, and blue: colors that can't be made by mixing other paints.

secondary colors
Orange, green, and violet: made by mixing two primary colors.

tertiary colors
Colors made by mixing a primary and a neighboring secondary color, like blue-green.

color wheel
A circle that shows how colors relate.

REMEMBER



WORDS & MORE

STEP BY STEP · MIX A SECONDARY COLOR

Make green.

1 Put a small puddle of yellow on your palette.

2 Add a tiny bit of blue and mix. (Blue is strong; add it a little at a time.)

3 Keep adding blue until you like the green.

Look for: Start with the lighter color and add the darker color slowly.

KEY IDEA

Primary colors mix to make secondary colors; primary + neighboring secondary makes tertiary colors.

CREATE · PAINT A COLOR WHEEL

Can you make every color on the wheel from three primaries?

You need: red, yellow, and blue paint; brush; water cup; paper towel; paper plate palette; the workbook color wheel template.

1 Paint the three primary colors in their spaces.

2 Mix and paint the three secondary colors.

3 Mix and paint the six tertiary colors.

4 Clean your brush between colors.

Record: your finished 12-part color wheel.

✓ REMEMBER

Primaries mix into secondaries and tertiaries on the color wheel.

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.5, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Red + yellow = ?
2. Name the three primary colors.
3. Name a tertiary color.

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.6
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.6: Value and Contrast

TODAY'S GOAL

I can make tints and shades, create a value scale, and use contrast to make something stand out.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: High-Contrast Picture.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.6 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Why are stop signs red and white, and school buses yellow and black?

2 Learn

Value is lightness or darkness. Add white to make a tint; add black to make a shade. A value scale shows the steps from light to dark.



WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

value
How light or dark a color is.

tint
A color made lighter by adding white.

shade
A color made darker by adding black.

contrast
A big difference between parts, such as light next to dark.

complementary colors
Colors opposite each other on the color wheel.

REMEMBER



Tints and shades of blue.

Contrast is a big difference, and it grabs attention. Light next to dark is high contrast. Complementary colors, which sit opposite each other on the color wheel (red and green, blue and orange, yellow and violet), also make strong contrast.

KEY IDEA

Tints are lighter, shades are darker; contrast (light vs dark, or complements) makes things stand out.

CREATE · HIGH-CONTRAST PICTURE

How can contrast make one thing stand out?

You need: paint or colored pencils; black and white paint or pencils; paper.

1. Make a 5-step value scale of one color, from tint to shade.
2. Draw a simple subject (a fish, a flower, a rocket).
3. Color the subject with one color and the background with its complement.
4. Check: does your subject pop out?

Record: your value scale and your high-contrast picture.

✓ REMEMBER

Value is light and dark; contrast makes parts stand out.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.6, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What do you add to make a tint?
2. What is the complement of blue?
3. Why are school buses yellow and black?

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.7
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.7: Composition

TODAY'S GOAL

I can plan a composition with a clear focal point and balance.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cr2

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Thumbnail Planning.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.7 (Parts B–D).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

When you take a photo, do you always put the main thing right in the middle? What happens if you don't?

2 Learn

Composition is how an artist arranges everything in the picture. A strong composition has a focal point, the spot your eye goes to first, and balance. Symmetrical balance is the same on both sides; asymmetrical balance uses different things that feel equally weighted.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

composition
How the parts of an artwork are arranged.

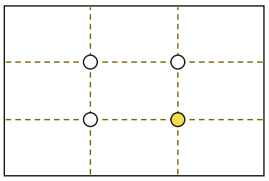
focal point
The part of an artwork your eye goes to first.

balance
How visual weight is spread out; symmetrical or asymmetrical.

thumbnail sketch
A small, quick drawing to plan an idea.

REMEMBER

Many artists place the focal point a little off center. Divide the picture into thirds both ways; the four places where the lines cross are strong spots for a focal point.



In The Great Wave off Kanagawa (about 1831), the Japanese artist Katsushika Hokusai placed a huge curling wave on the left and a tiny Mount Fuji low in the middle, framed by the wave.

WORDS & MORE

KEY IDEA

Plan the arrangement: choose a focal point (often off center), balance the picture, and try ideas small first.

CREATE · THUMBNAIL PLANNING

Which arrangement makes the strongest picture?

You need: pencil; paper.

1. Choose a subject: your pet, your house, or a favorite place.
2. Draw four small boxes (thumbnails).
3. Sketch the subject a different way in each: centered, off center, close up, far away.
4. Circle the strongest one and explain why.

Record: four thumbnails with your choice circled.

✓ REMEMBER

Plan with thumbnails; choose a focal point and balance.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.7, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a focal point?
2. What kind of balance is the same on both sides?
3. What is a thumbnail sketch?

REMEMBER

LESSON 1.8
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 1: The Elements of Art

Lesson 1.8: Revision and Kind, Specific Feedback

TODAY'S GOAL

I can give and use kind, specific, helpful feedback to improve my artwork.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr3, VA:Re9

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 1.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Draft, Feedback, Final.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 1.8 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

What's more helpful: “It's good!” or “The eyes look great; maybe make the background darker so your face stands out”?

2 Learn

Artists rarely get it right the first time. They make drafts, get feedback, and revise. Good feedback is kind (respectful), specific (names exactly what to look at), and helpful (gives an idea to try).

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

revise
To change and improve your work.

feedback
Comments that help someone improve.

critique
A thoughtful discussion of artwork.

REMEMBER

In a well-known video called Austin's Butterfly, a first grader named Austin draws a butterfly six times. After each draft, classmates give kind, specific feedback, and his final drawing is amazingly detailed. Watch it with your teacher if you can.

WORDS & MORE

Instead of…	Try…
"I like it."	"I like how your wavy lines make the water look like it's moving."
"It's bad."	"The house is small; could you make it bigger so it's the focal point?"
"Fix the colors."	"Try a complementary color behind the bird so it stands out."

KEY IDEA

Kind, specific, helpful feedback plus revision makes art (and everything else) better.

CREATE · DRAFT, FEEDBACK, FINAL

How much can feedback improve a drawing?

You need: your best thumbnail from Lesson 1.7; paper; colored pencils or paint.

1. Make a larger draft from your thumbnail.
2. Ask your teacher or a family member for one kind, specific, helpful comment.
3. Revise based on the feedback.
4. Add color, using value and contrast.
5. Put your draft and final side by side.

Record: your draft, the feedback, and your final piece for your portfolio.

✓ REMEMBER

Get kind, specific, helpful feedback, then revise.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 1.8, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Name the three parts of good feedback.
2. What did Austin do to improve his butterfly?
3. What does revise mean?

UNIT 1 REVIEW

Unit 1 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
1.1	Look closely; use the elements of art to describe what you see.
1.2	Lines vary in type and direction, and they carry feeling.
1.3	Shapes are flat; shading makes forms look 3-D.
1.4	Use guidelines: eyes halfway, nose and mouth below.
1.5	Primaries mix into secondaries and tertiaries on the color wheel.
1.6	Value is light and dark; contrast makes parts stand out.
1.7	Plan with thumbnails; choose a focal point and balance.
1.8	Get kind, specific, helpful feedback, then revise.

UNIT 2

Art Around the World

African masks and bronzes, kente and adinkra, Chinese calligraphy, landscape, and porcelain, early American portraits and buildings, and a family gallery.

People everywhere make art to celebrate, to remember, and to share what matters to them. In this unit you'll travel to West Africa to see masks, bronzes, and woven kente cloth, to China to practice calligraphy, paint misty mountains, and decorate porcelain-style pots, and to the early United States to study portraits and buildings, including one in Jackson. You'll finish by curating your own family gallery.

In this unit you will…

- Explain how art connects to culture and history in Africa, China, and early America.
- Use symbols and patterns, expressive brushstrokes, and atmospheric perspective.
- Create a pinch pot, a portrait with attributes, and a symmetrical building design.
- Curate, label, and present your artwork.

ART IN YOUR WORLD

Museum curators, textile designers, architects, and ceramic artists all study art from many cultures to create new work and to help people understand one another.

UNIT VOCABULARY

symbol	A picture that stands for an idea.
pattern	A planned repeating design.
calligraphy	Artistic handwriting.
porcelain	Fine white ceramic first made in China.
portrait	An artwork of a person.
curator	A person who arranges art for a show.

Lessons in this unit

Lesson	Title
2.1	Art of Africa: Masks and Leaders
2.2	Kente Cloth and Adinkra Symbols
2.3	Chinese Calligraphy
2.4	Chinese Landscape Painting
2.5	Chinese Porcelain: Blue and White
2.6	Early American Portraits
2.7	Early American Buildings
2.8	Curating a Family Gallery

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.1
Week 1 · Lesson 1 of 2

Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.1: Art of Africa: Masks and Leaders

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how African masks and the Benin bronzes were used and design a mask with symbolic features.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Cn11

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.1 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Paper Plate Mask.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.1 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

If you made a mask to show who you are, what would it look like? What colors and shapes would you choose?

2 Learn

Africa is a huge continent with more than 50 countries and thousands of cultures, so there is no single "African art." In

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

culture
The way of life of a group of people.

symbol
A picture or object that stands for an idea.

ceremony
A special event with traditions, such as a festival or celebration.

relief
A sculpture that sticks out from a flat background.

REMEMBER

many West and Central African cultures, artists carve wooden masks for ceremonies. A mask is usually worn with a costume by a dancer, along with music. The whole performance, not just the mask, is the artwork.

Masks use symbols. Among the Bwa people of Burkina Faso, tall flat plank masks are painted with black, white, and red geometric patterns that tell lessons about how to live. Among the Dan people of Liberia and Côte d'Ivoire, smooth oval masks with calm faces stand for beauty and peace. Exaggerated features, like big eyes or a tall forehead, often show wisdom or power.

Art also honored leaders. In the Kingdom of Benin, in what is now Nigeria, skilled metalworkers cast brass and bronze plaques and heads for the Oba, or king, starting more than 500 years ago. Plaques in relief showed the Oba in the center, larger than everyone else, to show his importance.

Feature	What it might mean
large eyes	seeing and knowing a lot; wisdom
tall forehead	intelligence
calm, closed mouth	self-control and peace
geometric patterns	lessons, rules, or stories
the biggest figure in a scene	the most important person

KEY IDEA

Many African masks are worn in ceremonies with music and dance. Their features and patterns are symbols. Benin artists honored the Oba with bronze reliefs.

✓ REMEMBER

African masks use symbols in ceremonies; Benin bronzes honored the Oba.

CREATE · PAPER PLATE MASK

How can shapes and colors stand for ideas?

You need: a paper plate; markers or paint; scissors (with an adult); yarn, paper strips, or beads.

1. Choose two ideas about yourself (such as kind, curious, brave).
2. Pick a symbol for each: a shape, a pattern, or an exaggerated feature.
3. Sketch your plan first, then make the mask.
4. Use at least one repeating geometric pattern.

Record: your mask and a label explaining what each symbol means.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.1, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is a symbol?
2. Who was the Oba?
3. Why might a mask have very large eyes?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.2
Week 1 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.2: Kente Cloth and Adinkra Symbols

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe kente cloth and adinkra symbols and create a pattern with meaning.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cn10

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.2 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Pattern Strips.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.2 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

What patterns can you find on the clothes, blankets, or curtains in your home?

2 Learn

Kente is a famous woven cloth from the Asante (Ashanti) and Ewe peoples of Ghana. Weavers use narrow looms to make long strips about 4 inches wide, then sew many strips together into a large cloth. Bright colors and bold geometric patterns each have names and meanings. Kente was once

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

pattern
Lines, shapes, or colors that repeat in a planned way.

weave
To make cloth by crossing threads over and under each other.

stamp
To press a carved shape with ink onto a surface.

motif
A shape or design that repeats in an artwork.

REMEMBER

worn only by royalty; today people wear it for graduations, weddings, and celebrations.

Kente color	Often stands for
gold	wealth and royalty
green	growth and harvest
blue	peace and harmony
red	strength and sacrifice
black	maturity and spiritual energy

Adinkra are symbols from Ghana that stand for proverbs and ideas. Artists carve them into pieces of calabash (gourd) and stamp them onto cloth in rows. Sankofa, a bird looking backward, means “go back and get it”: learn from the past. Gye Nyame stands for the power of God. Each repeating symbol is a motif.

WORDS & MORE

KEY IDEA

Kente is woven in strips with meaningful colors and patterns. Adinkra symbols stand for proverbs and are stamped in repeating rows.

CREATE · PATTERN STRIPS

How can a repeating pattern carry meaning?

You need: strips of paper about 2 inches wide; markers or crayons; a potato or foam piece and a pencil for a stamp (with an adult); paint.

1. Choose three colors and decide what each means to you.
2. Draw a geometric pattern that repeats along two or more paper strips.
3. Carve or press a simple symbol into a potato half or foam and stamp it in a row.
4. Glue the strips side by side, like kente.

Record: your pattern cloth and a key telling what your colors and symbol mean.

Safety: An adult should cut or carve the stamp.

✓ REMEMBER

Kente uses woven patterns and colors with meaning; adinkra symbols stand for proverbs.

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.2, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Where does kente cloth come from?
2. What does the Sankofa symbol mean?
3. What is a motif?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.3
Week 2 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.3: Chinese Calligraphy

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe Chinese calligraphy and use a brush to make thick, thin, and expressive strokes.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.3 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Brush Stroke Practice.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.3 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Write your name very slowly, then very fast. How does it look different? Does it show a different feeling?

2 Learn

In China, calligraphy, or beautiful writing, has been honored as one of the highest forms of art for more than 2,000 years. Chinese is written with characters, each built from strokes in a set order. A skilled calligrapher's strokes show energy, balance, and even the writer's mood.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

calligraphy
Beautiful, artistic handwriting.

stroke
One mark made by a brush or pen without lifting it.

character
A written symbol that stands for a word or idea in Chinese.

Four Treasures
The brush, ink stick, inkstone, and paper used in Chinese calligraphy and painting.

REMEMBER

Calligraphers use the Four Treasures: a soft-tipped brush, an ink stick made of soot and glue, an inkstone for grinding the ink stick with water, and paper (invented in China). Pressing down makes a thick stroke; lifting up makes a thin one. Because ink soaks in right away, each stroke must be made confidently, with no erasing.

Character	Meaning	Strokes
人	person	2
山	mountain	3
水	water	4
木	tree	4

STEP BY STEP · MAKE A CALLIGRAPHY STROKE

How do you make a stroke that starts thick and ends thin?

1 Hold the brush straight up, gripping it lightly near the middle.

2 Press down to start, so the bristles spread.

3 Move steadily and slowly lift as you finish.

Look for: Changing pressure changes the thickness of the stroke.

KEY IDEA

Chinese calligraphy is an honored art form. Calligraphers use the Four Treasures and change brush pressure to make thick and thin, expressive strokes.

CREATE · BRUSH STROKE PRACTICE

How does pressure change a brushstroke?

You need: a soft round paintbrush; black watercolor or ink; newspaper or thin paper; a cup of water.

1 Make a row of strokes, pressing harder on each one.

2 Make strokes that go from thick to thin and thin to thick.

3 Copy the character for mountain (山) three times, following the stroke order your teacher shows.

4 Circle your best one.

Record: your stroke practice page with your best character circled.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

✓ REMEMBER

Calligraphy uses brush pressure to make expressive thick and thin strokes.

Safety: Cover your work space; ink can stain.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.3, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What are the Four Treasures?
2. How do you make a thick stroke?
3. Why can't calligraphers erase?

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.4
Week 2 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.4: Chinese Landscape Painting

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe Chinese landscape painting and use overlapping and fading to show distance.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr2, VA:Re7

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.4 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Misty Mountain Scroll.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.4 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Look out a window. Are faraway trees as clear and dark as the ones up close? What do you notice?

2 Learn

Chinese artists call landscape painting shan shui, which means "mountain-water." For more than 1,000 years, painters have used brush and ink to show tall mountains, rushing waterfalls, misty valleys, and tiny people or houses. The paintings often show how small people are next to the greatness of nature.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

landscape
An artwork that shows natural scenery.

scroll
A long roll of paper or silk that holds a painting.

atmospheric perspective
Making faraway things lighter, bluer, and less detailed to show distance.

overlap
To place one shape partly in front of another.

REMEMBER

Many landscapes are painted on tall, hanging scrolls. One famous painting, Travelers Among Mountains and Streams by Fan Kuan, made around 1000 CE, shows a giant mountain towering over a line of tiny travelers and their mules. You have to look closely to find them!

Chinese painters show distance with atmospheric perspective: nearby mountains are dark and detailed, and faraway ones are pale and soft, as if seen through mist. They also overlap shapes, so closer hills cover part of farther ones. Empty paper becomes clouds, mist, or water.

WORDS & MORE

KEY IDEA

Chinese landscape painting (shan shui) shows mountains and water. Artists overlap shapes and make faraway things pale to show distance, and use empty space for mist.

CREATE · MISTY MOUNTAIN SCROLL

Can you show distance with dark and light ink?

You need: a long strip of paper (like a scroll); black watercolor; a brush; water in a cup.

1. Mix three values of gray: very light, medium, and dark.
2. Paint the farthest mountains at the top in the lightest gray.
3. Paint closer, overlapping mountains lower down in medium gray.
4. Paint the closest rocks and trees at the bottom in dark ink, and add one tiny person or house. Leave white space for mist.

Record: your finished scroll with three values and overlapping mountains.

✓ REMEMBER

Shan shui paintings use overlap, pale distant shapes, and empty space to show distance.

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.4, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does shan shui mean?
2. Who painted Travelers Among Mountains and Streams?
3. How do painters make mountains look far away?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.5
Week 3 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.5: Chinese Porcelain: Blue and White

TODAY'S GOAL

I can describe how Chinese porcelain was made and traded and decorate a pot with a blue-and-white design.

Standards: NCAS VA:Cr1, VA:Cn11

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.5 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Blue-and-White Pinch Pot.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.5 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Why do you think people call fancy plates and cups "china"?

2 Learn

Ceramics are made of clay hardened in a kiln. Chinese potters invented porcelain, a white, very hard, almost see-through ceramic made from a special white clay and

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

ceramics
Art made from clay and hardened by heat.

porcelain
A fine, hard, white ceramic first made in China.

kiln
A very hot oven for firing clay.

glaze
A glassy coating on ceramics.

REMEMBER

fired at extremely high heat. For centuries, people in other lands couldn't figure out how to make it. That's why fine dishes are still called “china.”

During the Ming dynasty (1368–1644), potters in the city of Jingdezhen made famous blue-and-white porcelain. They painted designs with cobalt blue under a clear glaze: dragons, flowers, waves, and clouds. Ships and caravans carried these pieces to Asia, Africa, the Middle East, and Europe, where artists tried to copy them.

Step	What happens
1. shape	Shape the clay on a potter's wheel or by hand.
2. dry	Let the piece dry slowly.
3. paint	Paint the design in cobalt blue.
4. glaze	Cover it with a clear glaze.
5. fire	Fire it in a kiln at very high heat; the glaze turns glassy.

KEY IDEA

Chinese potters invented porcelain. Ming blue-and-white porcelain, painted in cobalt blue under a glaze, was traded around the world.

CREATE · BLUE-AND-WHITE PINCH POT

Can you decorate a pot in the Ming style?

You need: air-dry clay (a ball about the size of an orange); a blue marker or blue paint and a thin brush; a pencil.

1 Push your thumb into the ball and pinch the walls evenly as you turn it.

2 Smooth any cracks with a wet finger and let it dry.

3 Plan a design with a border band and one main picture (a flower, wave, or cloud).

4 Paint the design in blue only.

Record: your pot and a sketch of your design plan.

✓ REMEMBER

Chinese potters invented porcelain; Ming blue-and-white ware was traded worldwide.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.5, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is porcelain?
2. What color did Ming potters paint with?
3. Why are fancy dishes called “china”?

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.6
Week 3 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.6: Early American Portraits

TODAY'S GOAL

I can explain how early American portraits show a person's importance and character, and draw a portrait with meaningful objects.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re8, VA:Cn11

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.6 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Portrait with Attributes.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.6 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

If someone painted your portrait, what objects would you want in it to show who you are?

2 Learn

Before cameras, painted portraits were the only way to remember what someone looked like. In the early United States, portraits also showed what kind of person someone was. Artists chose the pose, clothing, background, and

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

portrait
An artwork that shows a particular person.

pose
The way a person sits or stands in an artwork.

background
The part of a picture that seems farthest away.

attribute
An object in a portrait that tells something about the person.

REMEMBER

objects carefully.

Gilbert Stuart painted George Washington many times. His unfinished 1796 portrait is the face on the one-dollar bill. In his full-length Lansdowne Portrait, also from 1796, Washington stands with his arm stretched out like a speaker, beside a table with law books, a pen, and a sword. These attributes tell viewers he is a leader of a new nation of laws.

Charles Willson Peale painted more than 1,000 portraits, including many heroes of the American Revolution, and even started one of the country's first museums. Joshua Johnson, one of the first well-known African American portrait painters, painted families in Baltimore around 1800.

Part of the portrait	What it can tell us
pose	confident, thoughtful, or relaxed
clothing	job, wealth, or a special event
attributes (objects)	interests, work, or values, such as books for learning
background	where the person lives or what they care about

KEY IDEA

Early American portraits used pose, clothing, background, and attributes to show a person's importance and character.

CREATE · PORTRAIT WITH ATTRIBUTES

How can objects tell a viewer about a person?

You need: drawing paper; pencil; colored pencils; a mirror or a family member to draw.

1. Choose your subject: yourself (with a mirror) or a family member.
2. Lightly draw the head shape and place the eyes halfway down, as you learned in Unit 1.
3. Add a pose and at least two attributes that tell about the person.
4. Add a background that fits them.

Record: your portrait and a label naming each attribute and what it shows.

✓ REMEMBER

Early American portraits used pose, clothing, and attributes to show character.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.6, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. Whose face is on the one-dollar bill, and who painted it?
2. What is an attribute in a portrait?
3. Why were portraits important before cameras?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.7
Week 4 · Lesson 1 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.7: Early American Buildings

TODAY'S GOAL

I can identify columns, domes, and symmetry in early American buildings and design a building front.

Standards: NCAS VA:Re7, VA:Cn11

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.7 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Design a Building Front.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.7 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Picture a courthouse or a capitol building. What shapes do you see on the front?

2 Learn

When the United States was new, its leaders wanted buildings that looked strong, wise, and fair. They borrowed ideas from ancient Greece and Rome, the first places with democracies and republics. Many buildings have tall columns, a triangle-shaped top called a pediment, a round

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

architecture
The art and science of designing buildings.

column
A tall post that holds up part of a building.

dome
A rounded roof shaped like half of a ball.

symmetry
Balance in which both sides match like a mirror image.

Greek Revival
A style of building that copies the temples of ancient Greece.

REMEMBER

dome, and perfect symmetry.

Thomas Jefferson, the third president, was also an architect. He designed his home, Monticello, in Virginia, with columns and a dome, and he helped plan the University of Virginia. The U.S. Capitol in Washington, D.C., where Congress meets, has a huge dome and rows of columns.

Mississippi has an example too. The Old Capitol in Jackson, finished in 1839, is built in the Greek Revival style, with tall columns and a dome. It was Mississippi's capitol building for more than 60 years and is now a museum.

Column style	What its top looks like
Doric	plain and simple
Ionic	curled scrolls, like rolled paper
Corinthian	fancy, carved leaves

KEY IDEA

Early American buildings borrowed columns, pediments, domes, and symmetry from ancient Greece and Rome to look strong and wise. Mississippi's Old Capitol is a Greek Revival example.

CREATE · DESIGN A BUILDING FRONT

How do columns, a pediment, and symmetry make a building look important?

You need: drawing paper; a ruler; a pencil; a folded paper to check symmetry.

1. Fold your paper in half to find the center line.
2. Draw a pediment and four to six columns, matching on both sides.
3. Choose a column style: Doric, Ionic, or Corinthian.
4. Add a door in the center and a dome or steps if you like. Name your building.

Record: your symmetrical building design with its name and column style labeled.

✓ REMEMBER

Early American buildings used columns, domes, and symmetry borrowed from Greece and Rome.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.7, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What is symmetry?
2. Who designed Monticello?
3. What style is Mississippi's Old Capitol?

REMEMBER

LESSON 2.8
Week 4 · Lesson 2 of 2
Unit 2: Art Around the World

Lesson 2.8: Curating a Family Gallery

TODAY'S GOAL

I can choose, arrange, and label artworks for a family gallery and explain my choices.

Standards: NCAS VA:Pr4, VA:Pr5, VA:Pr6

TODAY'S ASSIGNMENT

- [ ] Read Lesson 2.8 in this book with your teacher.
- [ ] Do the Create activity: Family Gallery.
- [ ] Answer the Check Your Understanding questions in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part A.
- [ ] Complete the rest of Workbook Lesson 2.8 (Parts B–E).

1 Get Ready

LOOK AND WONDER

Think of a museum you have visited or seen in a video. How did you know where to look first?

2 Learn

A curator chooses which artworks to show, arranges them, and writes labels so visitors understand them. Now you'll be the curator of your own family gallery, using art you made in Units 1 and 2.

WORDS & MORE

WORDS TO KNOW

curator
A person who chooses and arranges art for a museum or show.

exhibit
A show of artworks arranged for people to see.

label
A small card that tells the title, artist, materials, and ideas of an artwork.

artist statement
A short paragraph in which an artist explains their work.

REMEMBER

Curator's step	What to do
choose	Pick four to six of your best or most meaningful pieces.
group	Put works together that share a theme, culture, or technique.
arrange	Hang them at eye level, with space between; put the strongest piece where eyes go first.
label	Write a label for each: title, your name, materials, and one sentence about it.
present	Give a short tour and read your artist statement.

STEP BY STEP · WRITE AN ARTWORK LABEL

A label for a blue-and-white pinch pot.

1 Title: Waves and Clouds

2 Artist and materials: Ellie, air-dry clay and blue paint, 2026

3 One sentence: Inspired by Ming porcelain, I painted a wave border and a cloud in the center.

Look for: A good label tells the title, artist, materials, and the idea behind the work.

KEY IDEA

Curators choose, arrange, and label art so visitors understand it. An artist statement explains your ideas and choices.

CREATE · FAMILY GALLERY

How can you share your art so visitors understand it?

You need: your artworks from Units 1 and 2; index cards for labels; tape or clips; a wall or table.

1 Choose four to six artworks and decide on a theme for your exhibit.

2 Write a label for each piece.

3 Arrange the gallery and invite your family.

4 Give a tour and read your artist statement.

Record: a photo or sketch of your gallery, your labels, and your artist statement.

✓ REMEMBER

Curators choose, arrange, and label art; artist statements explain the ideas.

WORDS & MORE

REMEMBER

WORDS & MORE

3 Check Your Understanding

✎ CHECK YOUR UNDERSTANDING

Directions: Answer each question. Write your answers in Workbook Lesson 2.8, Part A. Then check with your teacher.

1. What does a curator do?
2. Name three things on an artwork label.
3. Where should the strongest piece go?

UNIT 2 REVIEW

Unit 2 Study Guide

Use this page to get ready for the unit test. Read each big idea, then try the review pages in your workbook.

Lesson	Remember…
2.1	African masks use symbols in ceremonies; Benin bronzes honored the Oba.
2.2	Kente uses woven patterns and colors with meaning; adinkra symbols stand for proverbs.
2.3	Calligraphy uses brush pressure to make expressive thick and thin strokes.
2.4	Shan shui paintings use overlap, pale distant shapes, and empty space to show distance.
2.5	Chinese potters invented porcelain; Ming blue-and-white ware was traded worldwide.
2.6	Early American portraits used pose, clothing, and attributes to show character.
2.7	Early American buildings used columns, domes, and symmetry borrowed from Greece and Rome.
2.8	Curators choose, arrange, and label art; artist statements explain the ideas.

Glossary

architecture	The art and science of designing buildings.
artist statement	A short paragraph in which an artist explains their work.
artwork	Something an artist makes, such as a painting, sculpture, or print.
atmospheric perspective	Making faraway things lighter, bluer, and less detailed to show distance.
attribute	An object in a portrait that tells something about the person.
background	The part of a picture that seems farthest away.
balance	How visual weight is spread out; symmetrical or asymmetrical.
calligraphy	Artistic handwriting.
ceramics	Art made from clay and hardened by heat.
ceremony	A special event with traditions, such as a festival or celebration.
character	A written symbol that stands for a word or idea in Chinese.
color wheel	A circle that shows how colors relate.
column	A tall post that holds up part of a building.
complementary colors	Colors opposite each other on the color wheel.
composition	How parts are arranged.
contour line	A line that shows the outside edge of a shape.
contrast	A big difference that stands out.
critique	A thoughtful discussion of artwork.
culture	The way of life of a group of people.
curator	A person who arranges art for a show.
dome	A rounded roof shaped like half of a ball.
elements of art	Line, shape, form, color, value, texture, space.
exhibit	A show of artworks arranged for people to see.
feedback	Comments that help someone improve.
focal point	The part of an artwork your eye goes to first.
form	An object with three dimensions: height, width, and depth.
Four Treasures	The brush, ink stick, inkstone, and paper used in Chinese calligraphy and painting.
geometric shape	A shape with exact, regular edges, like a circle, square, or triangle.

glaze	A glassy coating on ceramics.
Greek Revival	A style of building that copies the temples of ancient Greece.
implied line	A line we imagine, like the path your eye follows.
kiln	A very hot oven for firing clay.
label	A small card that tells the title, artist, materials, and ideas of an artwork.
landscape	An artwork that shows natural scenery.
line	A mark that moves from one point to another.
motif	A shape or design that repeats in an artwork.
observe	To look closely and carefully.
organic shape	A free-flowing shape like those found in nature, such as a leaf or a puddle.
overlap	To place one shape partly in front of another.
pattern	A planned repeating design.
porcelain	Fine white ceramic first made in China.
portrait	A picture of a person, often the face.
pose	The way a person sits or stands in an artwork.
primary colors	Red, yellow, blue.
proportion	Size relationships.
relief	A sculpture that sticks out from a flat background.
revise	Change and improve.
scale	The size of something compared with something else.
scroll	A long roll of paper or silk that holds a painting.
secondary colors	Orange, green, and violet: made by mixing two primary colors.
shade	A color made darker by adding black.
shading	Adding darker values to show where light doesn't reach.
stamp	To press a carved shape with ink onto a surface.
stroke	One mark made by a brush or pen without lifting it.
symbol	A picture that stands for an idea.
symmetry	Balance in which both sides match like a mirror image.
tertiary colors	Colors made by mixing a primary and a neighboring secondary color, like blue-green.

thumbnail sketch	A small, quick drawing to plan an idea.
tint	A color made lighter by adding white.
value	How light or dark a color is.
weave	To make cloth by crossing threads over and under each other.

Grade 4 Art

Student Textbook

A full year of Grade 4 arts: drawing, painting, and design; music; art history; theater and dance; media arts; and sculpture. Every lesson pairs looking closely at real artwork with hands-on studio time, and the year ends with a portfolio and a show.

This Student Textbook teaches every lesson: the big idea, key vocabulary, models and examples, and a short set of practice problems to check understanding. It pairs with the Student Workbook and the Teacher Edition.

INSIDE THIS YEAR

01 The Elements of Art

02 Art Around the World

IN THIS BOOK

- Clear lesson goals: “I can…” statements
- Key vocabulary with student-friendly definitions
- Models, examples, and Key Idea summaries
- A study guide and glossary for every unit

THE COMPLETE SET



Textbook
You are holding this book

Workbook

Teacher Edition

Each lesson has the same number in all three books, so the textbook, workbook, and teacher pages always match.